

them are legendary chimera, some of the Fomorians, and even some of the Tuatha de Danaan.

Regardless of what societal or belief systems Denizens follow, they are rarely cavalier in their attitudes toward them. The fervor with which some Denizens follow their leaders or deities is beyond even the devotion of the most radical humans, and can become a driving force in their long lives. This is especially true for those who live by the Apolliae, and they follow their chosen masters with such zeal that even fanatics pale in comparison. However, they are not the only Ariá that can devote themselves wholly to worship or following; Araminae and Dioniae follow with equal zeal, especially if they can find a purpose that appeals to their desires, be they baser or more cerebral in nature.

Denizens and the Autumn World

Locked in the Dreaming and without the direct influence of Banality, Denizens were never forced to undergo the Changeling Way ritual. They have little love for those that have, regarding such lesser beings as changelings with disdain. More creatures of spirit, they do share the same Attributes — Strength, Intelligence, Appearance, etc. — but have no natural conduit to the mortal realm. Despite this, Denizens most often mimic human forms, due in large part to their conception by human minds, and do have tangible bodies in the Dreaming.

Denizens that choose to enter the Autumn world can do so in one of two ways: manifesting a physical form or temporarily possessing a Dreamer. While possession offers some protection from Banality, even merely sharing a mortal form is uncomfortable to most Denizens and abhorrent to others. Most notably, the fir-bholg and fuath cannot stand being confined in mortal flesh. This possession lasts only as long as the Denizen wishes, and she typically departs long before she risks a changeling's fate of coming Undone.

Manifesting a physical form of their own is more comfortable for all Denizens, but with no protection from Banality; those that do so burn bright and fast before they are forced to return to the Dreaming or risk death. Manifesting in this way costs the Denizen a point of Glamour a day, and in this form a Denizen cannot passively regain their Glamour. Balefires and dross of are thus of little consequence, and only through directly interacting with Dreamers is a Denizen's Glamour reinvigorated. A Denizen that falls to Banality in this form takes one health level of lethal damage a day (chimerical and real) until she returns to the Dreaming, where she recovers at the same rate.

Denizen Creation

Dark-kin character creation is similar to that of Kithain characters. They have the same Attributes, Abilities, and Backgrounds. They use the same Arts and Realms. Denizens do not have Banality as a trait (they are protected from Banality by their methods of entering the Autumn world).

Where a Denizen differs most, in terms of game Traits, from her Kithain counterparts is in her seemings and Legacies. Consult Chapter Three: Character Creation & Traits for more information about character creation.

Ariá

Denizens are bound by the Ariá, a trio of behaviors and forms that present in unique ways for each adhene. These are complex and subtle states, something completely alien and unknowable to changelings. They relate more deeply to the opinions and emotional state of the Denizen, and her relationship with the Dreaming itself. Ariá stand less as opposing philosophies, like the Seelie and Unseelie Courts, and are more of a personal choice of the Denizen.

Much like the way changelings favor one court over the other, one Ariá is always the most dominant in a Denizen. The remaining Ariá play small roles in a Dark-kin's life, but as circumstances change, may for a time become the ruling aspect of her personality. Most commonly, a change in Ariá occurs after a particularly intense emotional event, be it a tragedy, an epiphany of some sort, or some kind of spiritual awakening. Denizens suffer little backlash to changing Ariá — it carries almost none of the weight of changing court or seeming, and changes the way the Denizen reacts to the world around her instead of the way the world reacts to her. Without repercussions, Denizens are much more fluid and mercurial in the way they see and react to their environment. Without the lens of humanity, it is easier for these beings to remain in flux. In a way, it reflects the world they are used to, as the Dreaming itself is ultimately unknowable, and often changes to reflect common dreams.

Depending on a Denizen's adhene, her appearance may change drastically or not at all as her Ariá does. For example, an aonide changes very little, if at all, as she shifts; a moiræ, representing the Three Fates in the form of maiden, mother, and crone, takes on those forms as she shifts.

As the Ariá are more than simple changes on the surface of a Denizen's life, the three facets of her personality are all paired with a Legacy, much like the way a changeling's Legacies are tied to the courts. The dominant Ariá and its associated Legacy are the truest lens through which a Denizen sees the world. The secondary Ariá is fairly close to the surface, and is capable of influencing a Denizen's behavior; it will not override the primary Ariá, but can, in theory, coerce it. A denizen trusts her secondary Ariá, even if she does not prefer it. The tertiary Ariá is often little more than a whisper in the back of the Denizen's mind. It is a voice that has little to no bearing or influence on the Denizen, and if it can be heard is often dismissed. The tertiary Ariá is the most challenging lens for a Denizen to reflect on, and on the rare occasion that it manages to assert dominance, it makes a drastic change in her life and her personality.

Even though Denizens are more mercurial than changelings, mortals, and even Thallain, they most commonly switch between their primary and secondary Ariá. These two voices, and their associated Legacies, are the strongest aspects of her personality. The tertiary faces a much harder time in gaining dominance, as the way it interprets the world is somewhat alien. Should it come to the surface, a marked change comes over the Denizen in question. Despite the rarity of this occurrence, the